remain so lucky will become increasingly risky once North Korea becomes a fully capable nuclear weapons state.

Unlike a conventional military, where tanks, trucks, and even fighter planes are relatively simple instruments of war, operating nuclear weapons is a huge, expensive, and complex responsibility. Warheads must be specially maintained, as must the missiles that deliver them. Launch procedures are—or should be—complicated enough that no weapon can be fired on a whim, yet reliable enough that a national leader has confidence his nukes are ready when he is. Given the terrible responsibilities involved, nuclear personnel need to be carefully chosen and trained, since the most mundane procedures have the potential to turn into unimaginable catastrophes.

The warhead that detonates over a target is but one part of a complex system. The US government calls the warheads, missiles, launchers, communications networks, satellites, production and maintenance facilities, trucks, guards, bunkers, and the like—in other words, the entire system—the "nuclear enterprise." Having confidence in that enterprise—that the weapons are safe, are in place when needed, will work as desired and (as important) will *not* work when *not* desired, and that crews are fully trained—is known as "nuclear surety."

In conversations with former nuclear weapons officers, from the previous commander of US Strategic Command down to a retired US Air Force Minuteman III launch officer, each asserted that nuclear surety was the single most important thing they thought about, trained for, and responded to, day in and day out, every minute that they were on patrol, in the silo, or making national-level decisions about America's nuclear force. Nuclear surety, in other words, *is* the business of nuclear weapons.

"I focused on four main areas," noted retired US Navy admiral Cecil Haney, former commander of US Strategic Command (Stratcom) from 2013 to 2016, during which time he was the senior nuclear warfighting officer in the US military. "Those were manning, training, equipment, and certification. How did I select the right individuals, get them trained as highly as possible, and make sure my systems were certified